

Numerator: Ordered Linearly Independent k -tuples in $\mathbb{F}_q^n$ (an $n \times k$ matrix)

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \left(\begin{array}{c|ccc} v_{11} & v_{12} & \cdots & v_{1k} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ v_{n1} & v_{n2} & \cdots & v_{nk} \end{array} \right) \times \left(\begin{array}{c|ccc} v_{11} & v_{12} & \cdots & v_{1k} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ v_{n1} & v_{n2} & \cdots & v_{nk} \end{array} \right) \times \cdots \times \left(\begin{array}{c|ccc} v_{11} & v_{12} & \cdots & v_{1k} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ v_{n1} & v_{n2} & \cdots & v_{nk} \end{array} \right) \\
 & \quad \quad \quad \mathbf{v}_1 \neq \mathbf{0} \qquad \qquad \mathbf{v}_2 \notin \text{Span}(\mathbf{v}_1) \qquad \qquad \mathbf{v}_k \notin \text{Span}(\mathbf{v}_1, \dots, \mathbf{v}_{k-1}) \\
 & \quad \quad \quad q^n - 1 \text{ ways} \qquad \qquad q^n - q \text{ ways} \qquad \qquad q^n - q^{k-1} \text{ ways} \\
 \left[\begin{array}{c} n \\ k \end{array} \right]_q &= \frac{\quad}{\quad}
 \end{aligned}$$

Denominator: Ordered Bases for a fixed k -dimensional subspace (a $k \times k$ matrix)

$$\begin{aligned}
 & \left(\begin{array}{c|ccc} u_{11} & u_{12} & \cdots & u_{1k} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ u_{k1} & u_{k2} & \cdots & u_{kk} \end{array} \right) \times \left(\begin{array}{c|ccc} u_{11} & u_{12} & \cdots & u_{1k} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ u_{k1} & u_{k2} & \cdots & u_{kk} \end{array} \right) \times \cdots \times \left(\begin{array}{c|ccc} u_{11} & u_{12} & \cdots & u_{1k} \\ \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots \\ u_{k1} & u_{k2} & \cdots & u_{kk} \end{array} \right) \\
 & \quad \quad \quad \mathbf{u}_1 \neq \mathbf{0} \qquad \qquad \mathbf{u}_2 \notin \text{Span}(\mathbf{u}_1) \qquad \qquad \mathbf{u}_k \notin \text{Span}(\mathbf{u}_1, \dots, \mathbf{u}_{k-1}) \\
 & \quad \quad \quad q^k - 1 \text{ ways} \qquad \qquad q^k - q \text{ ways} \qquad \qquad q^k - q^{k-1} \text{ ways}
 \end{aligned}$$